HARD2BREAK

FREE GUIDE · JOSHUA HEALD

YOUR FIRST MUSCLE-UP

HOW OFTEN
Train each step 2 times a week, 3 if you're not too sore.

HOW LONG
About 1 to 3 months if you can already hang for a minute and do 10 pull-ups. 3 to 9 months if you're brand new.

YOU NEED
A pull-up bar and a cable machine with a lat pull-down bar.

Hit the goal on each step before you move on. That way you don't injure yourself.
Watch the original tutorial →

SWING AND PULL — PHASE 1



STEP 1
THE ROCK
10 ROCKS

1. Go into the L position.
2. Push the bar away from you and swing forward.
3. Try to bring your nose to the bar every single time.



STEP 2
L-POSITION CHEST-TO-BAR PULLS
5–10 REPS

1. Go into the L position.
2. Pull the bar straight to your chest, as hard as you can.
3. Touch the bar every single time, right below the nipple line.

DIP AND PRESS STRENGTH — PHASE 2



STEP 3
DEEP BAR DIPS
5–10 REPS

1. Hop up on the bar and dip down to the top of your chest.
2. Bring your feet up as you dip.
3. Push back up to the top.



STEP 4
CABLE PULL AND PRESS
5–10 REPS, GOOD AMOUNT OF WEIGHT

1. Take a narrow grip on the lat pull-down bar, with a good amount of weight.
2. Pull the bar straight to your chest.
3. Lean forward a little bit and press straight down.

LINK THE PIECES — PHASE 3



STEP 5 · ADDED STEP
ROCK TO CHEST-TO-BAR
5–10 REPS

1. Rock forward.
2. As you rock back, pull the bar to your chest.
3. Touch it. That's one rep.

I added this step for the last bit of strength and coordination you need for the muscle-up.



STEP 6
NEGATIVE REPS
5–10 CONTROLLED REPS

1. Start at the top of the bar.
2. Lower yourself all the way down, as slowly as possible.
3. Get back up and go again.



STEP 7 · ADDED STEP
NEGATIVES INTO A PULL-UP
5–10 GOOD REPS

1. Go up on the bar and lower slowly into a dip as you bring your feet up.
2. Go over the bar as slowly as possible.
3. At the bottom, rock forward and do a chest-to-bar pull-up.

THE MUSCLE-UP — PHASE 4



STEP 8
PUT IT ALL TOGETHER
1 YOUR VERY FIRST MUSCLE-UP

1. Swing down and rock. On the rock back, pull the bar aggressively to your chest.
2. As soon as it touches, rotate both arms at the same time, not one at a time.
3. Once your elbows are over, push down and lean forward as hard as you can.

AFTER THE LAST STEP

That's how you're going to get your very first muscle-up with some momentum. As that gets easier, the next stage is your strict muscle-up.

READY FOR THE NEXT SKILL?

The Hard to Break Program is six skills, every step from zero, with your workouts planned out. It's launching very soon. Join the waitlist and get two bonuses free: post-training stretching and rest-day mobility.

JOIN THE WAITLIST

Not medical advice. Train at your own risk and stop if something hurts. Terms: hardtobreakprogram.com/terms · @trainerjosh